

1. Introducing GPT-6 Astra for developers

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-05T23:27:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/5/introducing-gpt-6-astra-for-developers/>

Introducing GPT-6 Astra for developers Blink and you'll miss it, but there's a familiar creature at 1m59s : Across the board, Astra has more attention to detail, better understanding of the user's prompt, and can build more sophisticated outputs. In particular, it excels at building 3D models. I've seen it make incredible renderings of gardens, shipyards, animals , cityscapes, even Dyson spheres. Astra really does believe in putting a red neckerchief on a pelican riding a bicycle. Via Hacker News comment Tags: ai , openai , generative-ai , llms , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , gpt-6-astra

2. Using Blender with coding agents on macOS

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-05T15:51:09+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/5/blender-coding-agents-macos/>

TIL: Using Blender with coding agents on macOS I've been having fun with Blender in ChatGPT Codex on my Mac recently. Getting it to work with coding agents is really easy: install the full Mac application from blender.org and run a prompt like this: Use the already install /Applications/Blender to render a scene of a pelican riding a bicycle In this case I followed that up with these two prompts: OK add a background and a lot of flair Then: OK make it a whole lot better And got this image, generated using Blender's Python API : Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , blender , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , coding-agents , gpt-6-astra

3. Python 3.15.0 candidate 2 is here!

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-01T14:59:18+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/1/python-315-rc-2/>

Python 3.15.0 candidate 2 is here! Hugo van Kemenade (release manager for Python 3.14 and 3.15) announces the final release candidate for Python 3.15, scheduled for release in October: Entering the release candidate phase, only reviewed code changes which are clear bug fixes are allowed between this release candidate and the final release. [...] We strongly encourage maintainers of third-party Python projects to prepare their projects for 3.15 during this phase, and publish Python 3.15 wheels on PyPI to be ready for the final release of 3.15.0, and to help other projects do their own testing. Any binary wheels built against Python 3.15.0 release candidates will work with future versions of Python 3.15. Back in 2021 I found a bug in Python 3.10 by running my test suites against it... but I hadn't done this during the RC period, so that bug had already shipped! Since then I've always paid much closer attention to these RCs. The new RC isn't available for GitHub Actions just yet - keep an eye on actions/python-versions for that. For the moment though you can add this to a testing matrix: strategy : matrix : python-version : ["3.14", "3.15"] steps : - uses : actions/setup-python@v7 wi...

4. Gloria Steinem's Final Essay

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-05T19:42:43Z

Link:

<https://www.newyorker.com/culture/life-and-letters/gloria-steinems-final-essay?cndid=66114350>

Gloria Steinem, in a posthumous essay for The New Yorker: For me, saying that I am a feminist has always meant that I believe in the social, economic, and political equality of all males and females of all races and groups. I know this sounds too simple to need a word, but equality is still the exception, not the rule. Maybe we should call it egalitarianism, or even humanism. The problem with humanism is that it is often interpreted as being anti-religion, so I don't think it's inclusive enough. Regardless of what we call it, it just means treating each of us as uniquely human. The experiences of race and gender and class are very real and important, but they are also constructed and changeable. Our humanity is consistent and sacred. Still, for

some, it remains a mystery why women need a movement to distinguish our efforts toward equality. For me, it seems quite obvious. ?

5. ?Bob and Van?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-05T16:08:24Z

Link: <https://marco.org/2026/09/04/bob-and-van>

Marco Arment: And I can?t help but feel that maybe we were better off before we knew everyone?s hot takes on everything. The town coffee shop was just a coffee shop. We weren?t publicly shamed for going there because one of the owners was an ass. It was just a place to hang out with our friends. ?

6. Vinted

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-04T19:55:45Z

Link: <https://www.vinted.com/>

Remarking on MapQuest taking the #1 spot in the App Store (in the wake of their decision to ignore President Trump?s fiat renaming of Lake Ontario to ?Lake America?), I mentioned yesterday that I?d never heard of Vinted, the #3 app. (A day later and MapQuest is still #1, by the way.) Vinted, it turns out, is an eBay-like market for buying and selling used clothing. From a Lithuanian startup and the whole thing has been popular in Europe for a while, and obviously now is gaining popularity in the U.S. ?

7. Latent Powers

Source: Armin Ronacher?s Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-09-05T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/9/5/latent-powers/>

A few weeks ago I felt like it would be fun to see if I can make one of those cheap Chinese CarPlay dongles run something other than the stock firmware. The idea was that rather than just forwarding CarPlay, why not do something more interesting with them? They all work quite similarly: they act as bridges between your car and the phone. From there they deal with video and audio streams and pass some other data through. Most of them also bring up a custom UI for pairing and have a web interface that your phone can reach for updates. Long story short: I had a conversation with Fable and Sol via Pi about what could be done with such a dongle or whether I should use a Raspberry Pi instead if I wanted to do my own thing there. I figured it might be quite fun to run my own code while still allowing regular CarPlay to pass through. Through working with the LLM I learned about CatPlay , which is a Rust reimplementation of the CarPlay protocol that can run on Carlinkit devices. In particular, it can run on the Carlinkit Mini Ultra, which I figured would be easy enough to buy. I do have a few CarPlay adapters around, but I did not have that particular model, so I bought one on Amazon. Twen...

8. Proof of the rank-trace theorem

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 05 Sep 2026 17:04:13 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/05/proof-of-the-rank-trace-theorem/>

The previous post discussed the motivation for and application of the rank-trace theorem. This post will give a proof. Suppose A is a real symmetric matrix. The rank-trace inequality says where tr is the trace operator, the sum of the elements along the diagonal of the matrix. Terse proof Here?s the proof in a nutshell: diagonalize A [?] The post Proof of the rank-trace theorem first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Book Review: The Passing of the Dragon and Other Stories by Ken Liu ??????

Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 05 Sep 2026 11:34:47 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/book-review-the-passing-of-the-dragon-and-other-stories-by-ken-liu/>

This is a gorgeous set of short stories - and a good deal more accessible than some of the heavyweight prose Liu has previously been involved with. Some of the stories contain sentences which are complex jewels to be savoured. What I particularly like is the way he moves between almost-prosaic Earth-bound stories to the the most extraordinary flights of fancy. One story

might be set in a?

10. This Week in Package Management: 5 September 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-09-05T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/09/05/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week sixteen of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . I added Terraform, OpenTofu, Elm and PSResourceGet release feeds to the OPML this week. Releases pnpm 12.1 adds the workspace task scheduler to the Rust CLI, dispatching each package as soon as its dependencies finish where the previous scheduler waited for a whole topological batch, and moves login credentials into structured global config. 12.3 makes the global command shims native executables on every platform and extends the trust-policy flags to pnpm remove and pnpm update . On the 11.x line, 11.25 backports the task scheduler and adds --resume-from for recursive runs. rustup 1.29.1 checks for toolchain updates in parallel during rustup update and installs multiple components concurrently in rustup component add . Conan 2.32.0 adds LoongArch64 host detection, Xcode 26.6 and gcc 16.2 support, and lets XcodeToolchain accept arbitrary xcconfig build settings. PDM 2.29.0 exports editable local dependencies with relative paths in requirements files, and restricts locked packages to the platform they were resolved for when appending targets with pdm loc...

11. Reading List - 09/05/2026

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 05 Sep 2026 12:03:33 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-09052026>

SpaceX's turbine blade factory, Fervo's deal with Google, Delhi's cheap metro, why recycling is overrated, and more.

12. Pluralistic: Google skates (05 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 05 Sep 2026 08:04:11 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/05/divorce-court/>

Today's links Google skates: Another federal judge loses a game of peek-a-boo. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Memory-hacking ads; "Dzur"; NZ Ministry of DRM; Canadians v looking at the internet; Advice for self-publishers; Advice for writers; Why Wikipedia works. Upcoming appearances: D?browa Górnica, Warsaw, Brighton, London, Budapest, Edmonton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Google skates (permalink) Rome wasn't overthrown in a day. Oligarchies are stubborn, and by the time they've established and entrenched themselves, they have resources, power blocs and even mercenaries they can deploy to repel would-be dethroners. The USA got its first antimonopoly law, the Sherman Act, in 1890, but it took 22 years before that law could be used to crush John D Rockefeller's corrupt, sprawling empire. Senator John Sherman promoted his law as a way of preventing monopolies from emerging, warning the Senate that they would struggle to overthrow the "autocrats..."

13. avalanche technology

Source: computers are bad | Published: 05 Sep 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-09-05-avalanche.html>

One of the downsides of having written here for six years now is that my messy, ever-growing text file of topics for future articles contains a bunch of ideas that have been there for about six years. Part of the problem is that I just have to scroll so far up to even see them now, part of it is that some of them are on topics where I do not feel equipped to write a good formal treatment. So let's consider this an easy, breezy episode of Computers Are Bad as I knock out one of those items. One of these O. G. topics, line three, is "avalanche technology." I will admit that I am a little fuzzy on what this originally meant, but I have a few good guesses. First, though, let's just take a step back and talk a little bit about the

practicalities of the avalanche. For a lot of you, avalanches are probably a pretty abstract issue. For me, as well? I snowboard but I'm not that good at it, and the kind of mid-tier ski area where you will find me tumbling down the hill (Ski Santa Fe, towards Totemoff's) manages their slopes to avoid the potential for avalanche as much as possible. This requires some expertise in avalanche risks and it's never quite perfect, but it's pretty good. Snow that is...